University of Florida
College of Public Health & Health Professions Syllabus
PHC 6441: Understanding Health Disparities in the United States (3 credit hours)
Semester: Spring 2026
Delivery Format: Online
UF e-Learning in Canvas: https://ufl.instructure.com/courses/541281

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Office Hours: Tuesday from 9 a.m. – 10 a.m. or by appointment (in-person, phone, or via Microsoft Teams or Zoom)

Teaching Assistant: Nanyangwe Siuluta, PhD Candidate, MBChB, BScHb, MSc
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Office Hours: Wednesday from 11 a.m. to 12 p.m., Thursday from 4 p.m. to 5 p.m., or by appointment (via Microsoft Teams or Zoom)

Preferred Course Communications (e.g., email, office phone): **Please email me directly at ssc1987@ufl.edu, my preferred method of communication, not the Canvas message function.** If you use the Canvas message function, please expect a delay in response, as I do not check my inbox daily. **Please note:** Emails received on weekdays (Monday-Thursday) can expect a response within 24 to 48 hours. If I have not responded within two business days, please contact me again. Your message is important to me, but it may have been overlooked. Emails received after 5 p.m. on Friday or during the weekend will be answered by 3 p.m. on the following Monday (excluding holidays).

Prerequisites
Graduate elective course, or permission of the instructor

PURPOSE AND OUTCOME

Course Overview

This 3-credit graduate-level course examines health disparities and health equity in the United States through a social justice and population health lens. Students will explore how social, structural, cultural, and systemic factors shape health outcomes among historically marginalized populations, with particular attention to race, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, gender, and other intersecting identities. The course emphasizes culturally responsive public health practice and evidence-based strategies to advance health equity and eliminate health disparities. Course materials and assignments are intended to advance students' skills, providing them with the tools necessary to make a meaningful difference in achieving health equity.

The course is fully asynchronous and requires consistent weekly engagement with lectures, readings, discussions, and assignments. Learning is cumulative and interactive; logging in only during weeks when assignments are due does not constitute active participation.

Relation to Master of Public Health Foundational Domains

1. Compare the organization, structure, and function of healthcare, public health, and regulatory systems across national and international settings.
2. Discuss the means by which structural bias, social inequities, and racism undermine health and create challenges to achieving health equity at organizational, community, and societal levels.
3. Assess population needs, assets, and capacities that affect communities' health.
4. Apply awareness of cultural values and practices to the design or implementation of public health policies or programs.
5. Design a population-based policy, program, project, or intervention.
6. Discuss multiple dimensions of the policy-making process, including the roles of ethics and evidence.
7. Propose strategies to identify stakeholders and build coalitions and partnerships for influencing public health outcomes.
8. Advocate for political, social, or economic policies and programs that will improve health in diverse populations.
9. Apply principles of leadership, governance, and management, which include creating a vision, empowering others, fostering collaboration, and guiding decision-making.
10. Describe the importance of cultural competence in communicating public health content.
11. Apply systems thinking tools to a public health issue.

Course Objectives and/or Goals

Upon successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

1. Discuss the meaning and interrelated nature of health disparities, health inequities, health equity, and social justice.
2. Discuss the impact of prejudice and discrimination on health.
3. Describe the different health disparity and health equity frameworks and theories, and how these frameworks and theories are used to inform health equity work.
4. Provide an overview of the factors that drive disparities among key populations in the United States.
5. Evaluate the cultural factors of a society that contribute to health disparities using current literature
6. Appraise the components of programs and interventions to determine their systematic effectiveness in addressing health disparities and cultural factors.
7. Assess the role of public health practitioners in each system, ensuring their responsibilities, required skills, cultural competence, and knowledge of their target population are addressed.
8. Advocate for interventions, policy changes, human rights, economic circumstances, and health system attributes that promote the elimination of health disparities and improve health in diverse populations.
9. Define and discuss health equity research and collaboration approaches with respect to community-based participatory research, mixed methodologies, and collective impact.

Instructional Methods

This course is offered online, in weekly lessons. Each lesson is made up of the following:

1. Lectures/videos: Are for general orientation and will expand upon the week's content (posted in Canvas)
2. Assigned readings and materials: The instructor will also post lectures, course readings, supplementary materials, and resources on the course Canvas website. Readings and resources may be supplemented during the course

3. Discussions: Students are expected to participate actively in class discussions throughout the semester. Grades will be assigned based on accuracy, depth, and thoughtfulness of content
4. Assessments: A variety of assessments will be used to facilitate student learning, including course activity assignments and a health disparities advocacy portfolio

Course Announcements

Class announcements will be sent via the announcement tool in eLearning. Depending on your CANVAS notification settings, you may or may not receive email notifications. **Therefore, you are responsible for all information in these announcements, whether you see them in your email.**

Course Engagement and Expectations Policy

What is expected of you?

Because this is an **asynchronous online graduate course**, students are expected to engage **consistently and proactively** with course materials throughout the semester. Active participation requires regular interaction with the course content **each week**, not just during assignment weeks. Students are expected to log into the course **multiple times per week**, review weekly announcements, watch all assigned lecture videos, complete readings and learning activities, and participate meaningfully in discussion boards and other interactive components. Course content is released sequentially and may be referenced across lectures, discussions, and assignments; students are responsible for all posted materials regardless of login frequency.

This course utilizes **Canvas learning analytics** to support student success and monitor overall engagement. Analytics may include login frequency, access to course materials, and participation in course activities. Limited or inconsistent engagement may negatively impact discussion participation scores and overall course performance. Logging into the course solely to submit assignments does **not** constitute active participation. Graduate-level learning requires self-regulation, time management, and professional responsibility. Students are expected to manage their schedules to support sustained engagement and meaningful contributions to the learning community.

Instructor-Student Meetings and Support

Because this is a **100% asynchronous course**, intentional connection and individualized support are a priority. Each student is expected to participate in four one-on-one meetings with the instructor during the semester. Two sessions will focus on connection and student support, providing space to check in, discuss goals, reflect on progress, and ensure students feel supported, seen, and empowered in the course. Two additional meetings will focus specifically on the Health Disparities Advocacy Portfolio, including a mid-semester project development meeting and a pre-submission consultation before the final project due date. Meetings will be conducted via Zoom or Microsoft Teams and are designed to provide personalized guidance, feedback, and support.

Meetings will be scheduled using the instructor's online booking system, with available time slots provided in Canvas. While these meetings are supportive rather than evaluative, participation is expected in the course and directly supports student success. Students are responsible for scheduling and attending meetings during the suggested windows of Weeks 3 (initial connection meeting), Weeks 5 (portfolio development meeting), Weeks 9 (mid-semester support check-in), and Weeks 12 (final portfolio consultation). If a meeting must be rescheduled, students should notify the instructor in advance to arrange an alternative time. Students are encouraged to come prepared with questions or materials to make the most of each meeting.

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE CONTENT

Course Materials and Technology

Required Text for Course Book Discussion: Skloot, R. (2017). The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks. Broadway Paperbacks. ISBN-10: 9781400052189

Recommended Textbook: Smalley, K. B., Warren, J. C., & Fernández, M. I. (2020). Health equity: A solutions-focused approach. New York, NY: Springer Publishing Company.

Additional readings may be provided in the module lessons and posted on the instructor's Canvas website.

Course website: The course website: https://ufl.instructure.com/courses/541281. The weekly schedule, additional course materials, and links to submit course assignments and discussion posts are available through this website. You will log into the course website using your Gatorlink ID and password to access the course.

For technical support for this class, please contact the UF Help Desk at:

- helpdesk@ufl.edu
- (352) 392-HELP - select option 2
- https://helpdesk.ufl.edu/

Additional Academic Resources

Career Connections Center: Reitz Union Suite 1300, 352-392-1601. Career assistance and counseling services.

Library Support: Various ways to receive assistance with respect to using the libraries or finding resources.

Teaching Center: Broward Hall, 352-392-2010 or to make an appointment, 352-392-6420. General study skills and tutoring.

Writing Studio*:* 2215 Turlington Hall*,* 352-846-1138. Help with brainstorming, formatting, and writing papers.

Student Complaints On-Campus: Visit the Student Honor Code and Student Conduct Code webpage for more information.

Online Students Complaints: View the Distance Learning Student Complaint Process.

Enrollment Management Complaints (Registrar, Financial Aid, Admissions): View the Student Complaint Procedure webpage for more information.

DESCRIPTION OF COURSE CONTENT

Key Assignment Timeline

Week	Major Deliverables
Week 1	Introduction Post
Week 2	Discussion 1, Course Activity 1, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 3	Discussion 2, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 4	Course Activity 2, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 5	Discussion 3, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 6	Course Activity 3, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 7	Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 8	Course Activity 4, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 9	Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 10	Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 11	Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 12	Discussion 4, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 13	Book Discussion, Course Activity 5, Portfolio Development ongoing
Week 14	Final Advocacy Portfolio Due
Week 15	Course Activity 6

Topical Outline/Course Schedule

Dates	Topic(s)	Readings & Materials	Assignments/Activities
MODULE 1: FOUNDATIONS IN HEALTH DISPARITIES AND HEALTH EQUITY			
Week 1: **Jan 12 – Jan 16**	Defining the Landscape of Health Disparities	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 1 – Health Equity: Overview, History, and Key Concepts **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks: Prologue + Ch. 1-2 **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 1: In Sickness and In Wealth	**Introduction post (Infographic or Video):** Due: Friday, 1/17 at 11:59 p.m. EST
Week 2: **Jan 19 – Jan 23**	Prejudice, Discrimination, and Health	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 2 – Prejudice, Discrimination, and Health **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks: Ch. 3-6	**Discussion 1 due:** Initial post due: Thursday, 1/22 at 11:59 p.m. EST Replies due: Sunday, 1/26 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Course Activity 1:** Sunday, 1/26 at 11:59 p.m. EST

			Portfolio Development ongoing
MODULE 2: THEORETICAL FRAMEWORKS IN HEALTH DISPARITIES			
Week 3: **Jan 26 – Jan 30**	Health Disparities Frameworks and Theories, Part I: Social Determinants of Health (SDOH), Social Ecological Model (SEM), National Institute on Minority Health and Health Disparities (NIMHD) Research Framework	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 3 – Health Equity Frameworks and Theories **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks	**Discussion 2 due:** Initial post due: Thursday, 1/29 at 11:59 p.m. EST Replies due: Sunday, 2/9 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing** ***Individual Initial Connection meeting**
Week 4: **Feb 2 – Feb 6**	Health Disparities Frameworks and Theories, Part II: Intersectionality Theory, Minority Stress Theory, and Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs	**Read:** See Canvas for readings **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks	**Course Activity 2 due:** Sunday, 2/9 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing**
MODULE 3: EXAMINING HEALTH DISPARITIES FROM A POPULATION PERSPECTIVE			
Week 5: **Feb 9 – Feb 13**	Racial and Ethnic Minority Populations, Part I: Black or African American and Hispanic of Latino	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 5 – African American Health Equity **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 2: When the Bough Breaks	**Discussion 3 due:** Initial post due: Thursday, 2/12 at 11:59 p.m. EST Replies due: Sunday, 2/15 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing** ***Individual Portfolio Development Meeting**
Week 6: **Feb 16 – Feb 20**	Racial and Ethnic Minority Populations, Part II: Asian American, American Indian or Alaska Native (AI/AN), and Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander (NHPI)	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 6 – Health Equity in U.S. Latinx Populations **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 3: Becoming American	**Course Activity 3 due:** Sunday, 2/23 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing**

Week 7: **Feb 23 – Feb 27**	Low Socioeconomic Status (SES) Populations	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 7 – Asian American Health Equity **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 5: Place Matters	**Portfolio Development ongoing**
Week 8: **Mar 2 – Mar 6**	Underserved Rural Populations	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 8 – American Indian and Alaska Native Health Equity **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 4: Bad Sugar	**Course Activity 4 due:** Sunday, 3/7 at 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing**
Week 9: **Mar 9 – Mar 13**	Sexual Minority Populations	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 9 – Health Equity for Kānaka ʻŌiwi, The Indigenous People of Hawaiʻi **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 6: Collateral Damage	**Portfolio Development ongoing** ***Individual Mid-Connection meeting**
Week 10: **Mar 16 – Mar 20**	SPRING BREAK ☺ ***Continue reading: Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks**		
Week 11: **Mar 23 – Mar 27**	People with Disabilities	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 12 – LGBTQ Health Equity **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks	**Portfolio Development ongoing**
MODULE 4: CASE STUDY: THE STORY OF HENRIETTA LACKS			

Week 12: **Mar 30 – Apr 3**	The Case of Henrietta Lacks and Bioethics	**Read:** See Canvas for readings **Read:** Skloot – The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks	**Discussion 4 due:** Initial post due: Thursday, Apr 2 11:59 p.m. EST Replies due: Sunday, Apr 6 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing** ***Individual Final Portfolio Consultation**
Week 13: **Apr 6 – Apr 10**	The Legacy of HeLa Cells	**Read:** See Canvas for readings	**Book Discussions via Zoom to be held on:** April 7th – April 9th **Course Activity 5 due:** Sunday, Apr 20 11:59 p.m. EST **Portfolio Development ongoing**
MODULE 5: THE WAY FORWARD: ADVANCING HEALTH EQUITY, ELIMINATING HEALTH DISPARITIES, AND IMPROVING POPULATION HEALTH			
Week 14: **Apr 13 – Apr 17**	Community-Based Interventions and Policies	**Read:** See Canvas for readings **Watch:** Unnatural Causes Episode 7: Not Just a Paycheck	**Portfolio Project due:** Sunday, 4/20 at 11:59 p.m. EST
Week 15: **Apr 20 – Apr 24**	The Future of Health Equity	**Read:** Smalley, Warren, and Fernández: Ch. 19 – The Future of Health Equity	**Course Activity 6 due:** Sunday, Apr 20 11:59 p.m. EST Wednesday, 4/23 at 11:59 p.m. EST

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

Assignments

Introduction post (4% of Final Grade): During the first week of class, you will introduce yourself to your classmates by creating an infographic or video. This introductory activity is intended to foster connection, establish a collaborative learning environment, and support ongoing peer engagement throughout the course. Your introduction should highlight your academic or professional background, interests related to the course,

and goals for the semester. You are encouraged to be creative while maintaining a professional and respectful tone.

Discussions (16% of Final Grade): The exchange of ideas between colleagues is a key aspect of graduate learning and is a required activity in this course. Online discussions are designed to promote critical thinking, scholarly dialogue, and the application of course concepts through sustained peer interaction. You will be required to participate **in four discussion boards** throughout the semester. Each discussion is worth 4% of your final grade (40 points each), for a total of 16%. Required discussion weeks are **listed below** and will be indicated in the **weekly course announcements** and **the course calendar**.

- **Module 1 Discussion Topic:** Does Race Matter in the Elimination of Health Disparities
- **Module 2 Discussion Topic:** Theories of Practice and Health Equity
- **Module 3 Discussion Topic:** How Improving Health Literacy Can Advance Health Equity
- **Module 4 Discussion Topic:** Health Disparities and Bioethics

To receive full credit for each discussion, students must meet all the following requirements:

1) Initial post: Post one original response to the discussion question by Thursday at 11:59 p.m. (EST). The initial post should be 250-300 words (or the equivalent in VoiceThread, if used). Responses must be thoughtful, comprehensive, and demonstrate engagement with course concepts. Posts should incorporate course readings and lectures, with APA 7th edition citations where applicable.
2) Peer responses: Post two substantial responses to classmates by Sunday at 11:59 p.m. (EST). To encourage ongoing dialogue, at least one response must be posted on a day other than the day of the initial post. Peer responses should extend the discussion by offering new insights or perspectives, asking thoughtful, content-related questions, and connecting ideas to course materials or professional experiences. Similarly, agreeing with a peer without elaboration will not be considered substantive participation.

VoiceThread Participation (When Applicable): When indicated by the instructor, discussions may be completed using VoiceThread audio or video response in place of written posts. Initial VoiceThread posts should be approximately 2-3 minutes. Response posts should be 1-2 minutes. Video is encouraged, but audio-only responses are acceptable. VoiceThread contributions are held to the same standard of scholarly engagement, clarity, and citations as written posts.

Course Activities (30% of Final Grade): Students will complete six individual course activities throughout the semester, designed to assess understanding and application of key course concepts. Each activity is worth 5% of the final grade (50 points each), for a total of 30%. These assignments vary in format and length and address a range of topics related to health equity, health disparities, and social justice. Course activities may include visual or creative representations, comparative analyses of theories and frameworks, and applied exercises. Students may be asked to illustrate key concepts, compare theoretical models, analyze real-world examples, or reflect on community-level health disparities. All activities are to be completed independently. Detailed instructions and grading rubrics for each assignment will be provided in the corresponding Canvas module, and students are expected to follow all instructions carefully.

- **Module 1 Course Activity:** Illustrating Equality, Equity, and Justice
- **Module 2 Course Activity:** Applying the Social Ecological Model to Adverse Childhood Experiences

- **Module 3 Course Activity:** Population Health Data Interpretation Brief
- **Module 3 Course Activity:** Using Photovoice to Explore Environmental Health Disparities
- **Module 4 Course Activity:** Design Your Own Health Care System to Avoid Bias and Ensure Equitable Care for All Patients
- **Module 5 Course Activity:** Policy or Program Critique Through a Health Equity Lens

Book Discussion (20% of Final Grade): During the semester, students will participate in a live, synchronous book discussion conducted via Microsoft Teams or Zoom. During the course, students will read The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks by Rebecca Skloot and engage in a structured discussion focused on key themes, ethical considerations, and connections to course concepts. The book discussion will take place during **Week 13 (April 7–April 11**). Additional details regarding the discussion format, participation expectations, and meeting logistics will be provided closer to the scheduled date.

Final Project (30% of Final Grade): The final project for this course is a **Health Disparities Advocacy Portfolio** that integrates reflection, analysis, and the application of course concepts to advocacy. The portfolio consists of three interconnected components submitted **as a single, complete portfolio at the end of the semester**. **Part 1 (5%)** includes an initial reflection and learning goals that articulate the prior understanding of health disparities and the course objectives. **Part 2 (20%)** involves the development of advocacy-related artifacts with reflective annotations, including a health disparities case study, a community needs assessment, an infographic focused on the student's hometown or current community of residence, and a personal advocacy plan. These artifacts should demonstrate application of course concepts, evidence-based reasoning, and advocacy-oriented thinking. **Part 3 (5%)** is a final reflective essay that synthesizes learning across the course and portfolio components.

Although the portfolio is submitted in its entirety at the end of the semester, **specific weeks throughout the course are intentionally designed to support the development of individual portfolio components**. During these weeks, students are expected to work actively on relevant sections of the portfolio, even though no separate submissions are required. This structure is intended to support steady progress, reduce end-of-semester workload, and promote deeper reflection and integration of course concepts. Waiting until the end of the semester to begin working on the portfolio is strongly discouraged. Additional guidance, timelines, and evaluation criteria will be provided in Canvas.

Grading

Requirement	Due date	Points or % of final grade (% must sum to 100%)
Introduction post	Week 1	40 points or 4% of the final grade
4 Discussions (40 points each)	Ongoing	160 points or 16% of the final grade
6 Course Activities (50 points each)	Ongoing	300 points or 30% of the final grade
Book Discussion	Week 13	200 points or 20% of the final grade
Final Project	Ongoing	300 points or 30% of the final grade

Total		**1000 points or 100%**

Point system used (i.e., how do course points translate into letter grades).

Letter Grade	**A**	**A-**	**B+**	**B**	**B-**	**C+**	**C**	**C-**	**D+**	**D**	**D-**	**E**
Points earned	1000-930	920-900	890-870	860-830	820-800	790-770	760-730	720-700	690-670	660-630	620-600	<600

Please be aware that a C- is not an acceptable grade for graduate students. The GPA for graduate students must be 3.0 or higher based on 5000-level courses or higher to graduate. A grade of C counts toward a graduate degree only if it is based on credits in courses numbered 5000 or higher that have been earned with a B+ or higher.

You must include the letter-grade-to-grade-point conversion table below. UF fixes letter-grade-to-grade-point conversions and cannot be changed.

Letter Grade	**A**	**A-**	**B+**	**B**	**B-**	**C+**	**C**	**D+**	**D**	**D-**	**E**	**WF**	**I**	**NG**	**S-U**
Grade Points	4.0	3.67	3.33	3.0	2.67	2.33	2.0	1.33	1.0	0.67	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

More information on UF grading policy may be found at:
http://gradcatalog.ufl.edu/content.php?catoid=10&navoid=2020#grades

Policy Related to Make-up Exams or Other Work

Requirements: Students are responsible for all course material, including reading all required materials before each lecture. The course is conducted in eLearning, and all assignments, course lectures, discussions, emails, and quizzes will be delivered in this medium. Students should also read your email and course announcements several times a week. Please note that announcements and emails sent from the course site will go to your UFL email address (versus your Google, Yahoo, etc.). Please check this email at http://webmail.ufl.edu regularly as well. Students should also consult the course calendar to stay up to date on weekly deadlines.

Late assignments: Assignments turned in up to 24 hours late will be discounted by 5 points from the grade they would otherwise receive. Assignments turned in more than 24 hours late will be discounted by an additional 5 points per day unless arrangements have been made in advance with the instructor. Assignments submitted after 11:59:01 PM are LATE. The computer counts on-time submission up to 11:59:00 PM, so please do not wait until 11:54:00 or later to submit an assignment unless you understand that your assignment may be marked late. It is the responsibility of students to open their submission and verify not only that an assignment was submitted, but also that an attachment was uploaded and that it was the correct attachment.

Missed Assignments: Missed assignments and discussion posts will contribute zero points toward your final grade.

Makeup Assignments: If you are unable to meet a deadline in this course for approved reasons and have given prior notification to the instructor when possible, you will be given adequate time to make up any coursework missed. All other late or missed work will receive a grade of zero. Make-up exams will be provided only for excused absences or conflicts during final exams, per university policy, and MUST be discussed with the instructor in advance. Make-up exams will differ from the regularly scheduled exam.

Please note: Any requests for make-ups due to technical issues MUST be accompanied by the ticket number received from LSS when the problem was reported to them. The ticket number will document the time and date of the problem. You MUST email me within 24 hours of the technical difficulty if you wish to request a make-up.

Policy Related to Required Class Attendance

The UF policy on excused absences applies to all faculty. For information regarding the UF Attendance Policy, see the Registrar website for additional details:
https://catalog.ufl.edu/ugrad/current/regulations/info/attendance.aspx

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STUDENT EXPECTATIONS, ROLES, AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR INPUT

Expectations Regarding Course Behavior

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to comply with the University of Florida policy on academic integrity. As a student at the University of Florida, you have committed yourself to uphold the Honor Code, which includes the following pledge:

"**We, the members of the University of Florida community, pledge to hold ourselves and our peers to the highest standards of honesty and integrity**."

You are expected to exhibit behavior consistent with this commitment to the UF academic community. On all work submitted for credit at the University of Florida, the following pledge is either required or implied:

"On my honor, I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid in doing this assignment."

It is your individual responsibility to know and comply with all university policies and procedures regarding academic integrity and the Student Honor Code. Violations of the Honor Code at the University of Florida will not be tolerated. Violations will be reported to the Dean of Students Office for consideration of disciplinary action. For additional information regarding Academic Integrity, please see Student Conduct and Honor Code or the Graduate Student Website for further details: https://www.dso.ufl.edu/sccr/process/student-conduct-honor-code/ ; http://gradschool.ufl.edu/students/introduction.html

Please remember that cheating, lying, misrepresentation, or plagiarism in any form is unacceptable and inexcusable behavior.

Online Faculty Course Evaluation Process
Students are expected to provide professional and respectful feedback on the quality of instruction in this course by completing course evaluations online via GatorEvals. Guidance on giving feedback professionally and

respectfully is available at https://gatorevals.aa.ufl.edu/students/. Students will be notified when the evaluation period opens, and can complete evaluations through the email they receive from GatorEvals, in their Canvas course menu under GatorEvals, or via https://ufl.bluera.com/ufl/. Summaries of course evaluation results are available to students at https://gatorevals.aa.ufl.edu/public-results/.

Communication Guidelines

Contacting the course Instructor, Dr. Canidate, when you have: grading assignments questions, course material questions, if you have a scheduling conflict, suspect a grading error, a family emergency, a technical issue, or are behind in the course. http://studentlife.online.mph.ufl.edu/when-to/when-to-send-e-mail-to-the-instructor/

Please keep the following things in mind when emailing the instructor.

1. **Be Formal:** Use a proper salutation when emailing, and finish with a "Thank you." This is true for other professors and employers as well.
2. Use a **subject line**; please don't leave it blank.
3. **Specify** who you are by first and last name, and specify which class you are taking before diving into the specifics. I often teach multiple classes per semester and usually have hundreds of students to serve. **State your name, the class you are taking, and the course section** (I might teach three sections of your course and will need to know which one you attend).
4. **Be thorough-** Any time you send a message, you should have two things in mind: goal and audience. Your audience here is me, your professor. Your goal could be any number of things, from clarifying the reading assignment to asking for an extension. Whatever your goal, anticipate any questions I may have and incorporate the information into your message.
5. **Be kind-** Professors are people, too. We have friends, families, hobbies, and favorite foods. So, when you email a professor, remember that you are not writing to an entity, a building, or a computer — you are communicating with a real person. Be kind, be thankful, and don't come across as demanding.
6. **Allow time**- If you need advice or clarification on an assignment, avoid emailing the night before it is due. You might not get a timely reply.
7. **Proofread-** The final step, proofreading, ensures that you come across as professional and caring. An email full of errors and faulty sentence structure may distract from your message.

SUPPORT SERVICES

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities
If you require classroom accommodation because of a disability, it is strongly recommended that you register with the Dean of Students Office http://www.dso.ufl.edu within the first week of class or as soon as you believe you might be eligible for accommodations. The Dean of Students Office will provide you with documentation of accommodations, which you must then give to me, the instructor of the course, to receive them. Please do this as soon as possible after you receive the letter. Students with disabilities should follow this procedure as early as possible in the semester. The College is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to assist students in their coursework.

Counseling and Student Health
Students sometimes experience stress from academic expectations and/or personal and interpersonal issues that may interfere with their academic performance. If you find yourself facing problems that have the potential

to or are already negatively affecting your coursework, you are encouraged to talk with an instructor and/or seek help through the University resources available to you.

- The **Counseling and Wellness Center** (352-392-1575) offers a variety of support services, including psychological assessment and intervention, and assistance with math and test anxiety. Visit their website for more information: http://www.counseling.ufl.edu. Online and in-person help is available.

- **U Matter We Care** website: http://www.umatter.ufl.edu/. If you are feeling overwhelmed or stressed, you can reach out for help through the You Matter We Care website, which is staffed by the Dean of Students and Counseling Center personnel.

- The **Student Health Care Center** at Shands is a satellite clinic of the leading Student Health Care Center located on Fletcher Drive on campus. Student Health at Shands offers a variety of clinical services. The clinic is located on the second floor of the Dental Tower in the Health Science Center. For more information, contact the clinic at 392-0627 or check out the website at: https://shcc.ufl.edu/

- Crisis intervention is always available 24/7 from: Alachua County Crisis Center: (352) 264-6789 http://www.alachuacounty.us/DEPTS/CSS/CRISISCENTER/Pages/CrisisCenter.aspx

- **University Police Department**: Visit UF Police Department website or call 352-392-1111 (or 9-1-1 for emergencies).

- **UF Health Shands Emergency Room / Trauma Center:** For immediate medical care, call 352-733-0111 or go to the emergency room at 1515 SW Archer Road, Gainesville, FL 32608; Visit the UF Health Emergency Room and Trauma Center website.

Do not wait until you reach a crisis to come in and talk with us. We have helped many students through stressful situations that have impacted their academic performance. You are not alone, so do not be afraid to ask for assistance.

Inclusive Learning Environment

Public health and health professions are based on the belief in human dignity and on respect for the individual. As we share our personal beliefs inside or outside the classroom, we do so with the understanding that we value and respect the diversity of backgrounds, experiences, and opinions, so that every individual feels valued. We believe in and promote openness and tolerance of differences in ethnicity and culture, and we respect differing personal, spiritual, religious, and political values. We further believe that celebrating such diversity enriches the quality of the educational experiences we provide our students and enhances our own personal and professional relationships. We embrace The University of Florida's Non-Discrimination Policy, which reads, "The University shall actively promote equal opportunity policies and practices conforming to laws against discrimination. The University is committed to non-discrimination with respect to race, creed, color, religion, age, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, marital status, national origin, political opinions or affiliations, genetic information, and veteran status as protected under the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act." If you have questions or concerns about your rights and responsibilities regarding an inclusive learning environment, please see your instructor or refer to the Office of Multicultural & Diversity Affairs website at www.multicultural.ufl.edu.